

Azure Test Plans

What each option is for

The manual & exploratory testing module of Azure DevOps — plan, run and record tests with full traceability to work items, bugs and pipelines.



What is Azure Test Plans?

The testing module of Azure DevOps. It lets you plan, run and record manual and exploratory tests against an application, keeping full traceability with the rest of the project — user stories, bugs and pipelines.

FOR HUMAN TESTERS

Test Plans

Testers step through scenarios by hand and record exactly what they observe — pass, fail, bugs and evidence.

FOR PIPELINES

Automated tests

Run automatically inside a pipeline. Test Plans is the complement — the place for the checks a person performs.



Key concepts

1

Test Plan

The main container. Groups all the tests for a period or sprint, tied to a project area and iteration. e.g. "Sprint 3 – Regression".

2

Test Suite

A grouping of test cases inside a plan, organised by feature, module or technical criterion.

3

Test Case

A work item describing a scenario, step by step. Each step has an Action and an Expected Result.

4

Test Runner

The interface where the tester runs a case live, marking each step Pass or Fail and logging bugs or evidence.

Three types of Test Suite

BUILT BY HAND

Static suite

You add test cases one by one. Full manual control over what belongs in the suite.

FROM A WORK ITEM

Requirement-based

Created from a PBI or User Story. Every case inside is automatically linked to that requirement.

DRIVEN BY A QUERY

Query-based

Uses an Azure Boards query to pull work items dynamically. Any new PBI that matches appears on its own — no manual step.

Test plans

The main view of the module — the entry point for the whole manual testing flow.

FROM HERE YOU CAN

- Create and manage Test Plans
- Navigate the tree of suites
- Add and execute test cases
- Assign testers to each case

PRIMARILY USED BY

QA / Tester

This is where plans, suites and cases come together — the starting point before any test is run.

Progress report

Shows the execution state of a Test Plan in real time.

Not Run

Passed

Failed

Blocked

Every test case rolls up into one of four states

IT INCLUDES

- Total test cases, and how many are Not Run, Passed, Failed or Blocked
- Progress charts by suite or by tester
- Filters by configuration or period

PRIMARILY USED BY

QA Lead / Scrum Master

See at a glance whether the sprint is ready to close.

Parameters

Reusable values you can drop into the steps of a test case.

WITHOUT PARAMETERS

user@company.com written into five different test cases.

Change the value? You edit it in five places.

WITH PARAMETERS

Define @email once and reference it everywhere.

Change the value? You update it in a single place.

When to use: the same steps repeat with different data (multiple users, environments, etc.). **Used by:** QA

Configurations

Define the environment combinations the same test case is run against.

Windows 11 / Chrome

Android 14 / Chrome

iOS 17 / Safari

HOW IT WORKS

Once assigned to a suite, the case appears duplicated — one instance per configuration. Each can carry a different result (Pass on desktop, Fail on mobile).

PRIMARYLY USED BY

QA / DevOps

Ideal for projects with multi-platform compatibility requirements.

Runs

The history of every test-case execution in the project.

Each time a tester runs a case — alone or in batch — a Test Run is generated.

FROM THIS SECTION YOU CAN

- Review past runs with date, tester and result
- Open a run to inspect the step-by-step detail
- Compare results across executions

PRIMARILY USED BY

QA Lead / Audit

Useful for auditing and for spotting flakiness — tests that sometimes pass and sometimes fail.

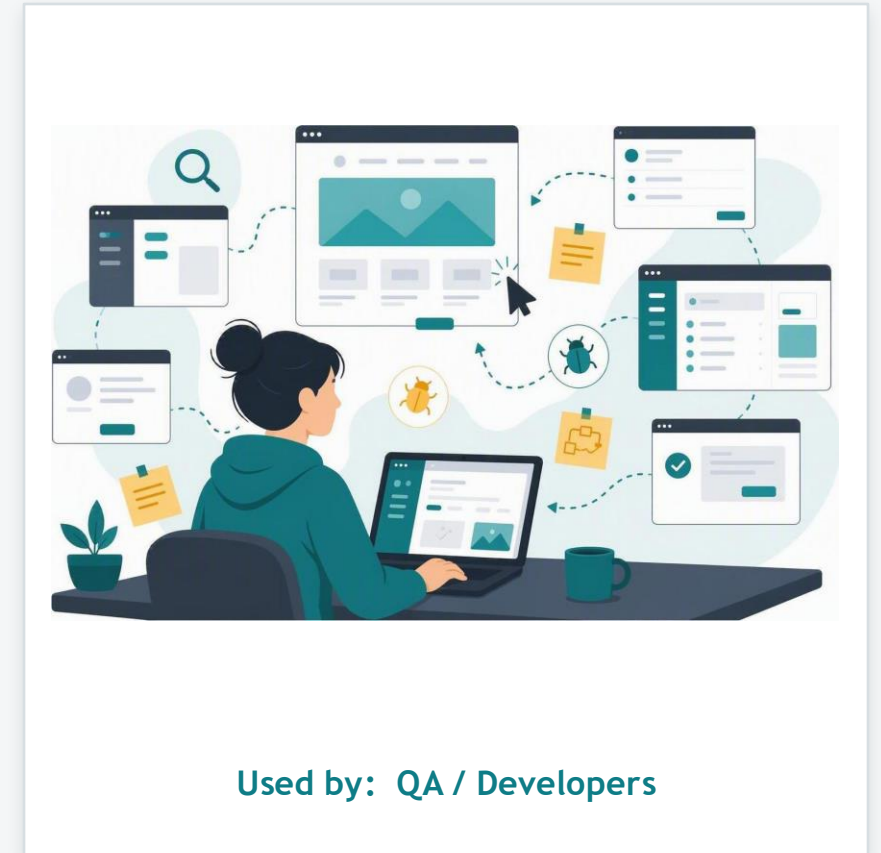
Exploratory sessions

Record free, unscripted testing — the tester roams the app hunting for unexpected behaviour.

DURING A SESSION THE TESTER CAN

- Capture screenshots or record video
- Log bugs straight from the browser
- Link findings to a User Story or feature

On close, Azure DevOps builds a summary with time spent, bugs found and notes taken. Great for early stages or when there's no time to write formal cases but you still want a record.



Used by: QA / Developers

The options at a glance

Option	What it's for	Mainly used by
Test plans	Create & manage plans, suites and cases	QA / Tester
Progress report	Track sprint execution progress	QA Lead / Scrum Master
Parameters	Reusable data inside test cases	QA
Configurations	Run one case across many environments	QA / DevOps
Runs	History of executions	QA Lead / Audit
Exploratory sessions	Free testing with no pre-written cases	QA / Developers